Worksheet A: Hypotheses and Falsifiability

Name: _____ Date: _____

Task 1: Falsifiable or not?

in class, small groups, 10 min.

For each statement, decide whether it is falsifiable *in its present form* (yes / no / only after it has been made more precise). Falsifiable means: you can name an observation that would contradict the statement. For every testable statement, give a concrete observation that would refute it. Rephrase vague statements so that they become testable. (The statements were written for this exercise.)

S1 "Honest people sleep better."

S2 "Students who sleep on average at least seven hours a night in the week before an exam score, on average, more points in that exam than students who sleep less than five hours."

S3 "Everything that happens happens for a reason, even if we cannot always see it."

S4 "Astrologers can match a birth chart to the correct one of three personality profiles more often than chance."

S5 "The remedy works for everyone who is open to it. Anyone who feels no effect was not inwardly ready."

No.	falsifiable?	Refutation condition or more precise version
S1		
S2		
S3		
S4		
S5		